



# Patterns of Religious/Spiritual Engagement Among Sexual and Gender Minorities of Color

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# Health Disparities in SGMs

## Depression

- Lesbian/Gay individuals have 1.87 higher odds (Wittgens et al., 2022)
- Bisexual individuals have 2.70 higher odds (Wittgens et al., 2022)
- TGD individuals have apprx. 30% higher rate (Liu et al., 2024)

## Alcohol Use Disorder

- Lesbian/Gay individuals have 1.68 higher odds (Wittgens et al., 2022)
- Bisexual individuals have 1.50 higher odds (Wittgens et al., 2022)

## Suicide

- Lesbian/Gay individuals have 2.89 higher odds (Wittgens et al., 2022)
- Bisexual individuals have 4.81 higher odds (Wittgens et al., 2022)
- TGD individuals large diff. ( $d = 0.84-1.10$ ) (Valen et al., 2025)

# Religiousness/Spirituality and SGM Health

Religiousness can contribute to SGM health disparities

- anti-LGBT+ state legislation (Todd et al., 2024)
- Religiously-based family expectations (Kim et al., 2024)
- Internal conflict (Gibbs & Goldbach, 2015)

# Do SGMs care about religion?

Yes!

48% of SGMs identify as religious (Public Religion Research Institute, 2024) and highly value religion (Conron et al., 2020).

## How and when does R/S contribute to SGM well-being?

Emerging work suggests, there is large heterogeneity in how R/S is associated with SGM health.

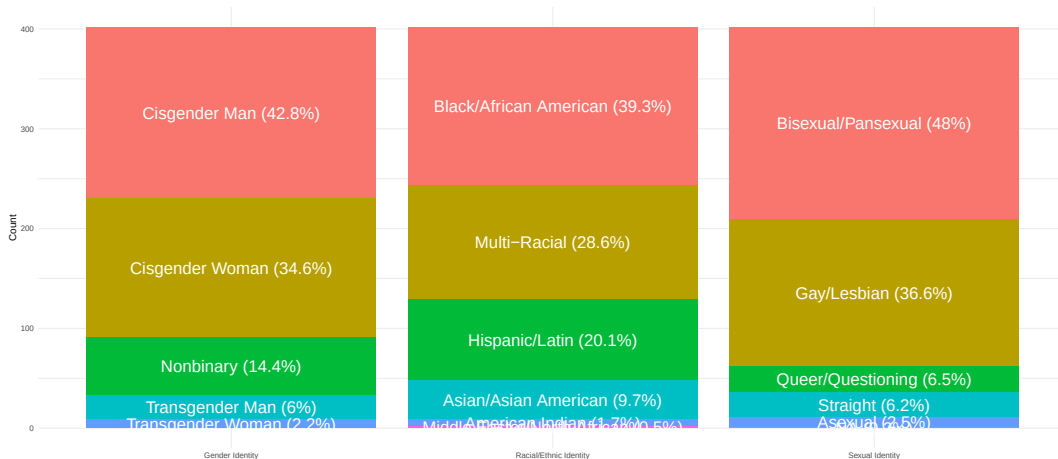
R/S can contribute to disparities AND wellbeing.

# Existing studies

Prior studies focus on:

- 1 Mostly White SGMs
- 2 LDS or Christian only samples

# Participants and Procedure (N=401)



# Measures Pt. 1

## Behavioral Measures of R/S

- Service Attendance (i.e., not including funerals)
- Spiritual Activity (i.e., prayer, scripture, meditation)

## Psychological Measure of Religiousness

- Religious Commitment (i.e., intrinsic religious commitment)

## Social Measure of Religiousness

- Sense of Belonging with Religious Community

## Measures Pt. 2

### Mental Health

- PHQ-9

### LGBTQ+ Measures

- Internalized Homonegativity
- LGBTQ+ Community Connectedness

### Religious Outcome Measures

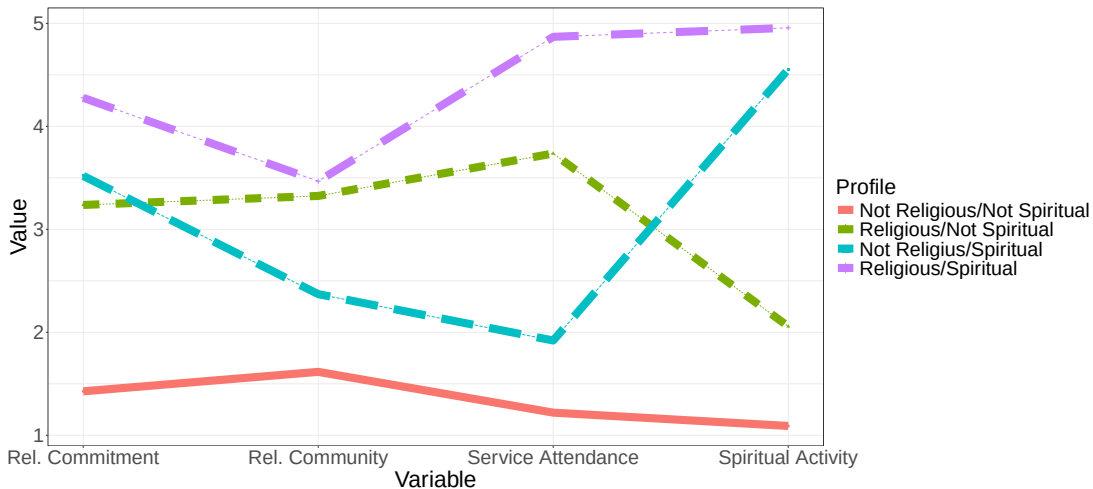
- Religious and Sexual/Gender Identity Conflict
- Interpersonal Religious Struggles

# Analysis Plan

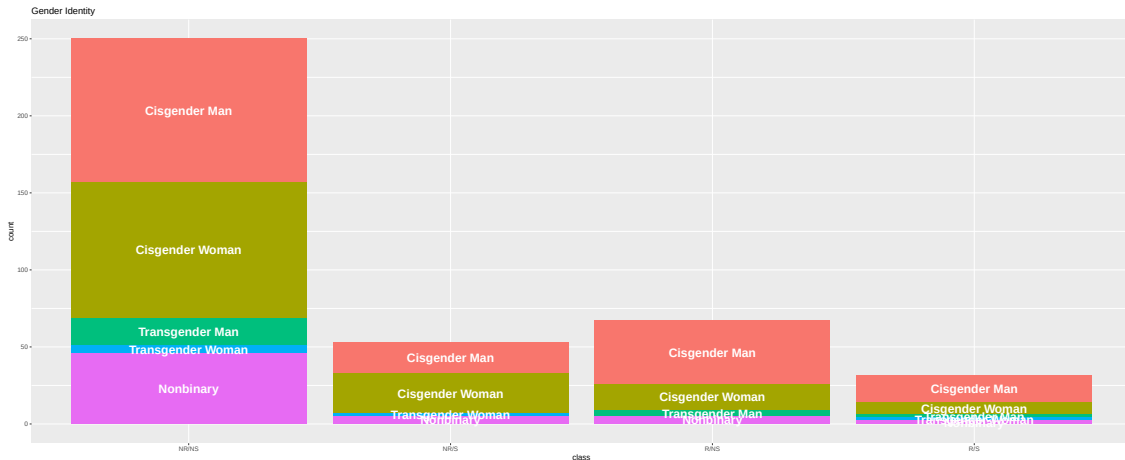
All analyses were performed in R and viewable on Github and OSF.

- Latent profile analysis tidySEM package
- Multinomial logistic regression using profile probabilities
- BCH distal outcome

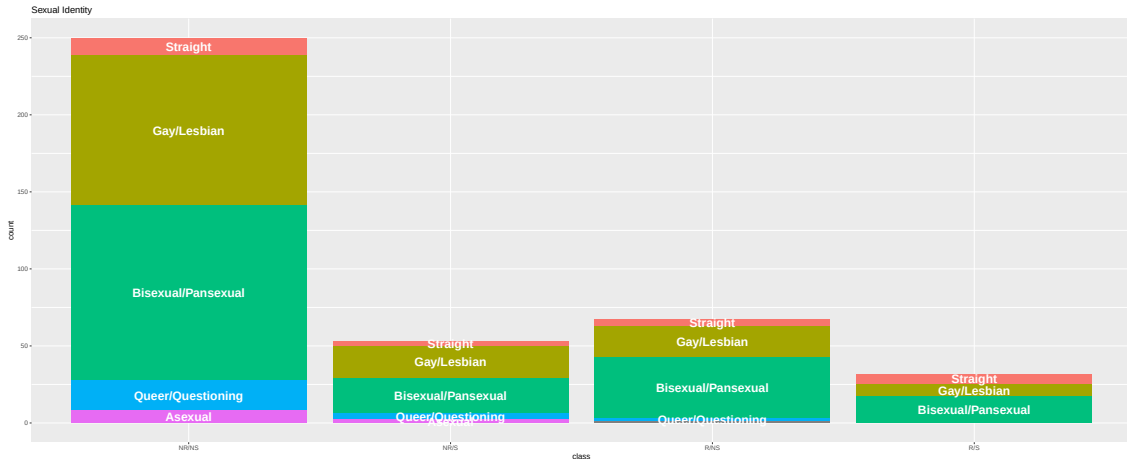
# Latent Profile Analysis



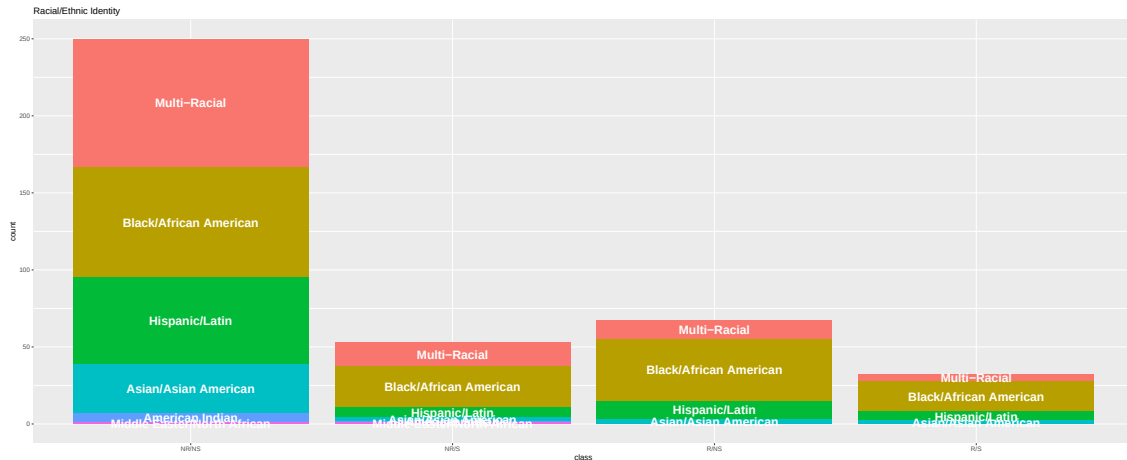
# Demographic Predictors: Gender Identity



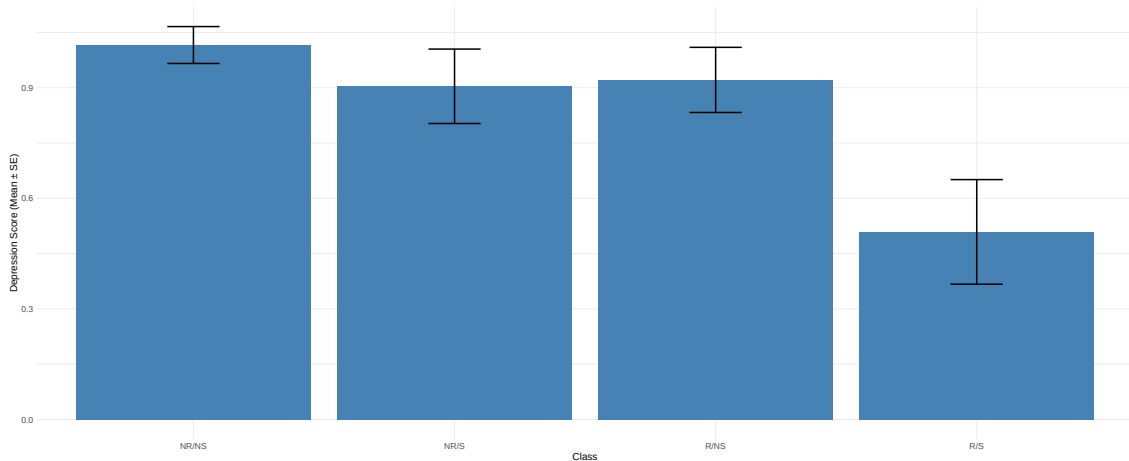
# Demographic Predictors: Sexual Identity



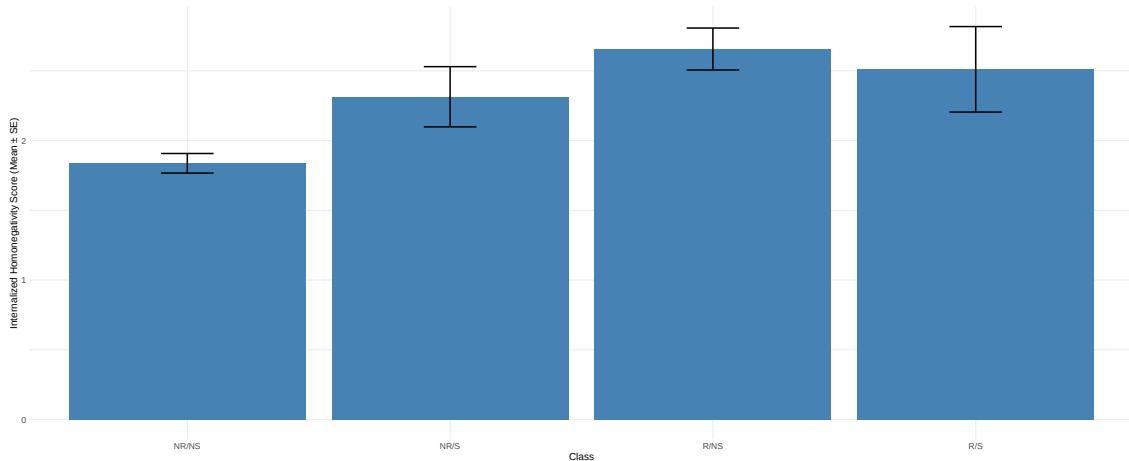
# Demographic Predictors: Racial/Ethnic Identity



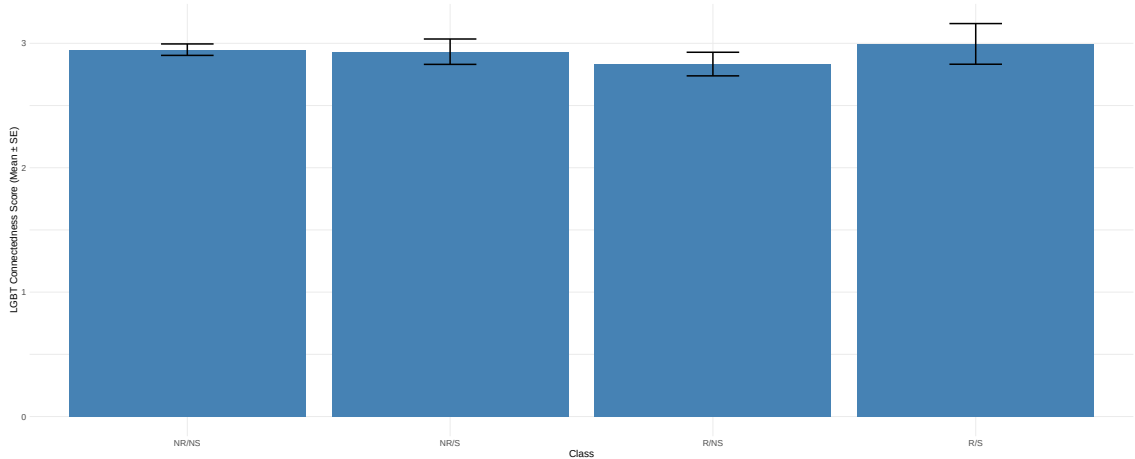
# Outcome: Depression



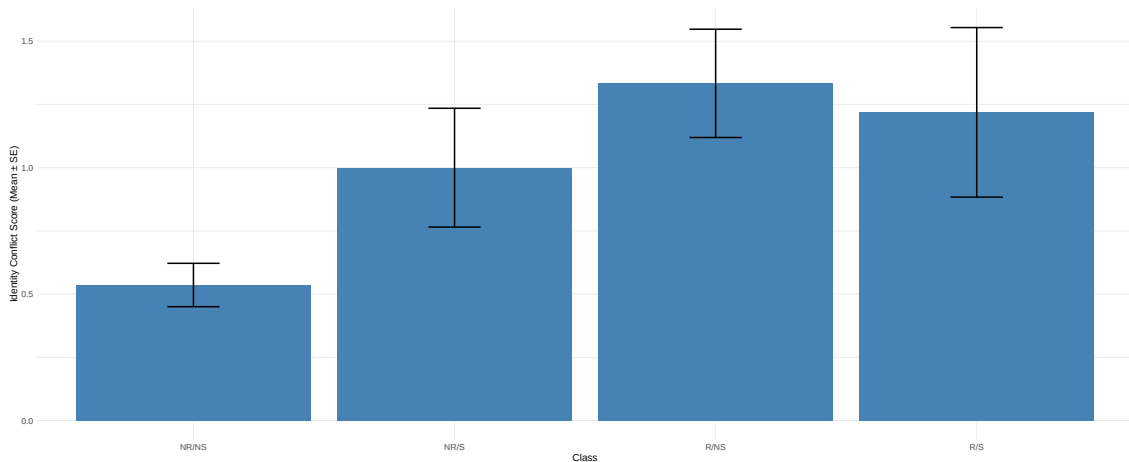
# Outcome: Internalized Homonegativity



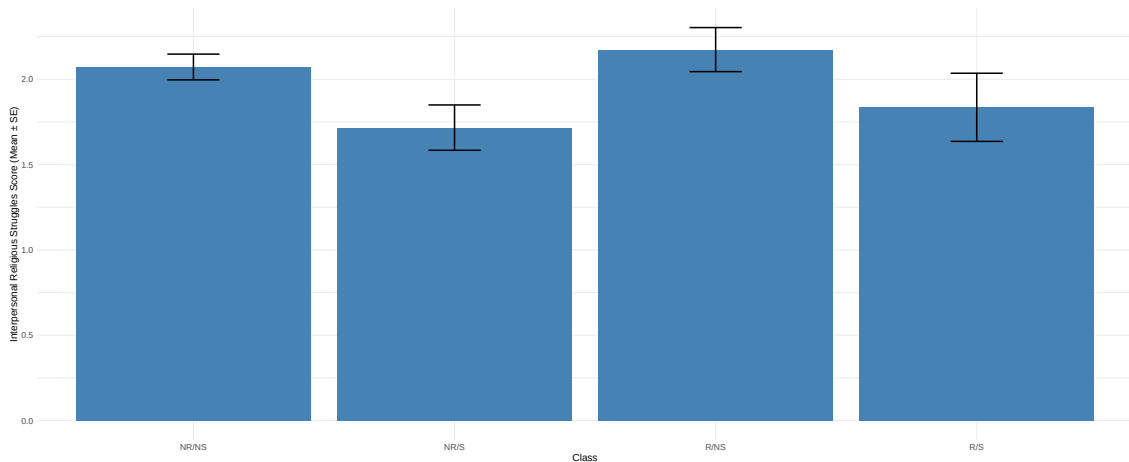
# Outcome: LGBT Community Connectedness



# Outcome: RS/SGL Conflict



# Outcome: Interpersonal Religious Struggles



## R/S matter to SGMs

- Although most SGMs were NR/NS, a substantial majority are in some form.
- Regardless of R/S engagement, all report high levels of connectedness to LGBT Community

### Key point

This reflects the broader literature, 48% of SGMs are religious, and also highly value religion.  
**Religion matters to SGMs.**

## R/S engagement is linked to health and identity development

- R/S SGMs reported the lowest levels of depression
- NR/NS reported lowest levels of internalized stigma
- NR/NS reported lowest levels of internal conflict

### Key points

- 1 R/S can promote health AND
- 2 R/S can promote stressors

## Future directions

- ➊ Using psychometrically validated measures of religiousness and spirituality.
- ➋ How and when does R/S promote health in SGMs?
- ➌ Why do some racial/ethnic SGMs report higher R/S engagement than others?